Reading comprehension exercise

You are going to read an article about going to pop concerts. Six sentences have been removed. Choose from A-G the one which fits each gap (1-6). There is one extra sentence.

A. This noise went on for around twenty minutes before my patience ran out.

B. But there are also times when the greatest performers in the world can't compete with the idiot in the crowd who decides to sing along, spill drinks and casually push people.

C. These days, though, I am much less keen on all this.

D. If this reaction was a bit strong, the emotion behind it was understandable.

E. I always walk out whenever they start doing that.

F. Some unwritten ones, however, do exist.

G. Talking, for example, is acceptable but not to the point where the strangers next to you are forced to listen to details of your private life.

Quiet, please: rock gig in progress

Talking loudly at a pop concert these days can get you told off - and don't even think of spilling your drink. Fiona Sturges welcomes this change in attitudes.

Last week a well-known singer is reported to have shouted al an audience member in response to their talking loudly throughout his performance, after which he is said to have emptied a glass of water on their head. 1/…. Who hasn't been lo a gig at some point and had their night ruined by the behaviour of a stranger? 1

People's enjoyment of a concert relies on the good manners of others. At its best, live music can be a life-changing experience. When everything goes right, the music coming from the stage can lift the soul and make you forget your surroundings. 2/…. 2

Something like that happened when I went to see one of my favourite bands. It was a sit-down gig and I had a seat about ten rows from the front. Despite being so near the stage, I couldn't hear a thing thanks to a group of people sitting in front of me, who kept on gossiping and laughing al the way through the show. 3/…. And that's when I leaned forward and asked, as politely as I could, if they could keep it down. They were absolutely shocked. 'How dare you!' replied one of them. 3

When il comes lo audience interaction. every art form requires a certain amount of appropriacy although there are no formal rules. 4/…. For instance, it's acceptable to move around and talk in art galleries but wild dancing is. as a general rule, not tolerated. 4

In the theatre you can sit down and fall asleep and no one will care, but anyone who talks at anything louder than a whisper or answers their mobile phone is asking for trouble. Actually, at one city-centre venue. posters on the walls forbid gig-goers from

talking during performances altogether. But generally, when il comes to pop concerts it's more a case of attitudes starting lo change. 5/…. Singing along loudly is unreasonable unless the artist specifically requests it. And drinks should be consumed by their owner and not spilt down the back of the person in front of them. 5

The habits of gig-goers vary according to the type of music being performed. From the hard-rocking gigs of my teenage years, I frequently emerged soaked in drinks and sweat, and thought nothing of standing in the middle of a crowd for hours. 6/…. 6
Happily, I have learned that the further back you stand in a crowd, the less likely you are to be pushed or have someone step on your foot. As for the talkative ones in the audience, I say pour cold water on the lot of them.

Listening comprehension exercise

You will hear part of a radio interview with Sonia Evans, artist whose work first became popular on the Internet. questions 1-7, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

What did Sonia most want to do when she was a girl?
A create sculptures
B paint using colours
C draw with a pencil
Answer

What disappointed Sonia about the exhibition in the art gallery?
A not enough people saw her drawings
B there was a bad review of her drawings
C nobody bought any of her drawings
Answer

Sonia decided to use the Internet to show her drawings because…
A she did not want to go and live somewhere else
B the gallery refused to hold another exhibition of her work.
C her friend had already promoted his photos that way
Answer

What made Sonia's video different from the others?
A Her work had more artistic quality.
B The film was more professionally made.
C It did not show a completed picture.
Answer

How did Sonia feel when she found out how many people had looked at her video?
A rather uncomfortable
B highly delighted
C quite relieved
Answer

What happened as a result of the success of her videos?
A She drew more and more pictures
B She began sleeping less at night.
C She started to forget what time it was.
Answer

How did she react to negative comments about her work?
A She replied angrily to them
B She started to become depressed
C She stopped reading them.
Answer

Sentence transformation

For questions 1-6, complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first sentence, using the word given. **Do not change the word given**. You must use between two and five words, including the word given. Here is an example:

It's a long time since we last went there.
BEEN
We .....HAVEN'T BEEN THERE FOR. .... a long time.

By eight o'clock I couldn't read because it was so dark.
ENOUGH
By eight o'clock it wasn't _____ read.

Despite his poor eyesight, my grandfather continued to read books.
CARRIED
Despite his poor eyesight, my grandfather _____ books.

I stopped doing ballet when I was at primary school.
DONE
I _____ I was at primary school.

The plot was so complicated that none of us could follow it.
TOO
The plot was _____ us to follow.

I've had Chinese lessons since this time last year.
LEARNING
I _____ exactly a year.

You can't be sure you'll win the prize, you know.
COUNT
You can't _____ the prize, you know.

Writing a review of
books, films, series, documentaries, hotels, restaurants, experiences …

Here are some general tips:

Write about 4 paragraphs, containing:
- introduction and setting
- outline of the story and main characters
- comments on various aspects of the book
- conclusion and recommendation

Some useful adjectives:

absurd bizarre breath-taking delightful dreadful exceptional fine moving mysterious outstanding poor predictable remarkable slow-moving superb tremendous

Some useful expressions:
- My advice is to avoid X ... and instead ...
- X ... is really worth ... because ...
- This X is one of the best ... I have ever ... , so I suggest ...
- I would advise everyone to … a better … than X, such as…
- Anyone who likes ... will really enjoy X ...

TASK:

You see this notice in an international English-language magazine.

Have you read a good novel recently? lf so, would you like to write a review of it? Include information on the setting, story and main characters, and say whether you would recommend the book to other readers.

Write your review in 140-190 words.

****

Writing · review: your answer (140-190 words)

Have you read a good novel recently? Write a review of it.

Title:

Grammar Reference

GERUND AND INFINITIVE

- Some verbs are followed by **to + infinitive**, and some others by**-ing**
- Some verbs can be followed by both **to + infinitive** or **-ing**.
- Some verbs can be followed by either **to + infinitive** or **-ing**, and the meaning changes

✓ I **tended to see** it as just the first step.
✓ They **agreed to show** some of my drawings.
✓ I **didn't bother trying** to have anything else shown.
✓ He never actually **got round to doing** it.
✓ I **started going** to the opposite extreme.
✓ I **started to become** a bit too obsessed.

1- Decide which of these verbs are followed by to + infinitive, and which by -ing. Then write an example:

- appear
- avoid
- dislike
- enjoy
- expect
- finish
- imagine
- insist on
- keep (on)
- learn
- manage
- mind
- miss
- offer
- promise
- refuse
- seem
- suggest
- threaten
- want

2- Match the sentence halves and explain the difference in meaning.

I went on watching
I went on to watch

another DVD after that one had ended.
the same DVD for another hour.

He tried working in theatre
He tried to work in theatre

but he never managed to get a job.
but he earned very little money.

I regret saying that
I regret to say that

you have not been chosen to appear in the new film.
you had no talent at all.

I'll remember watching
I'll remember to watch

that film for many years.
that film on TV tonight!

We stopped talking to
We stopped to talk to

the neighbours in the street last night.
the neighbours because they were so rude.

I won't forget visiting
I won't forget to visit

the film studios last year.
my grandmother next week.

3- Correct the mistakes in these sentences

1. When I arrived home, I could not stop thinking about why I had agreed helping him.
2. My fellow students have suggested to buy her a DVD or a book.
3. I forgot asking you whether you have an email address.
4. It was my first time at primary school and I remember to be very frightened.
5. I don't mind to work hard sometimes.
6. You will get into trouble if you go on to behave like that.

Gerund and infinitive · answers to exercises 2 and 3

2- Match the sentence halves and explain the difference in meaning.

1. I went on watching / I went on to watch
2. He tried working in theatre / He tried to work in theatre
3. I regret saying that / I regret to say that
4. I'll remember watching / I'll remember to watch
5. We stopped talking to / We stopped to talk to
6. I won't forget visiting / I won't forget to visit

3- Correct the mistakes in these sentences

1. When I arrived home, I could not stop thinking about why I had agreed helping him.
2. My fellow students have suggested to buy her a DVD or a book.
3. I forgot asking you whether you have an email address.
4. It was my first time at primary school and I remember to be very frightened.
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4- Complete the news story with the to+infinitive or the -ing form of the verbs in brackets.

Cinema audiences still rising

The latest cinema audience figures, which appear (1) _____ (show) an increase of twelve per cent on the same period last year, seem (2) _____ (indicate) that the economic downturn has not stopped people (3) _____ (go) to watch their favourite films. Film critic Nick Kaminski says: 'These days people are trying (4) _____ (spend) less money, and as an evening out at the cinema is much cheaper than, say, going to a restaurant, many of them are choosing (5) _____ (see) a film rather than have a meal out. I expect the figures will keep on (6) _____ (rise).

PRESENT PERFECT (review)

5) Correct the mistakes in these sentences.

1- I'm living in this nice, small town for one year now.

2- Let me tell you more about what I've done last month.

3- I have been living here since a month.

4- I already have printed my boarding pass for my flight.

5- We've waited all this time. Did you miss the bus?

6- I'm at the beach because my holiday has ended yet.

Which tense is used for something ...

a- that happened in a period of time that is finished?
b- that started changing or developing in the past and is still happening now?
c- that started in the past and is permanent or has a result now?

a: b: c:

6- Look at these sentences:

I've wanted to have a dog for a while.

We've just moved to a smaller flat.

I haven't asked my parents yet.

My eyes have been getting sore since I began reading a lot of texts online last year

I've already had to start using reading glasses.

Match the underlined words with uses a-e.

a) for something that has happened sooner than expected
b) to say how long something has been happening
c) for an event that is expected to happen
d) to say when something that is happening started
e) for something that happened a short time ago

Phrasal verbs with ON

7- Look at these verbs. What does each one mean? Make a sentence with each phrasal verb.

1- rely on

2- keep on

3- step on

4- go on

8- Complete the sentences with phrasal verbs. Use the correct form of these verbs +on.

base-	carry-	count-	depend-	focus-	jump-	log-
play-	sit-	turn-				

1. During the concert, somebody from the audience _____ the stage.
2. I'll _____ to my computer to find out more about the composer of that music.
3. At the cinema I asked some people to be quiet, but they just _____ talking.
4. The success of a film often _____ the amount of publicity it gets and what the critics say.
5. There's nothing to _____ at that art gallery and standing up all the time gets tiring.
6. The gig was supposed to finish at 10.30, but the band _____ until after midnight.
7. At the cinema, they always _____ all the lights after the film has finished.
8. The film is _____ real events in a small town in southern USA.
9. 'You're a good friend and I know I can always _____ your support,' he said.
10. The story begins by looking at her childhood while the second half _____ her adult life.